

community's ability to elect who they wish to the Board, so we tend to always have a mix of Red Hat employees and volunteers, which changes in a fairly smooth and continuous way every six months.

Q Tell us something about the Fedora Docs Project. What are the objectives and the to-dos?

The Docs Project is responsible for creating user-oriented guides and tutorials for Fedora, and also to keep our wiki-based information fresh and well-groomed. Although I don't get to participate in the Docs Project as often or as deeply as I used to, I still spend significant time keeping up with its tasks.

Right now, the most important task on which the Docs Project is engaged is fixing up our own process documentation, so we can enable all the new contributors

to participate fully in writing, editing and publishing. We have an enormous virtual hack-fest happening over the Christmas and New Year holidays, where we will be training new volunteers on how to use tools, edit the wiki, and publish to the Web. In addition, we hope to also make some choices for an upcoming content management system that will make all these tasks easier in the future.

Q What do you think are the best features of Fedora 10? And your personal favourites?

I'm very excited about two capabilities in particular. One is PackageKit, and the other is our enhancements to virtualisation. Richard Hughes has built up some incredible capabilities for desktop interaction that, for Fedora 10, allow automatic search and installation of media codecs, which is very helpful for desktop users. In

community worldwide as a force multiplier for the goals of Red Hat.

In short, our job is to ensure that Red Hat is a good citizen in open source communities, and that the same community lessons that have made Fedora successful are applied to other strategic Red Hat projects -- in the education realm, in the OLPC work that Red Hat is part of, etc.

The Community Architecture team still is very active in Fedora—especially in organising FUDCons, worldwide events, and in being the place inside Red Hat that is responsible for Fedora's non-engineering budget.

Therefore, the team really has two focuses. One is an internal focus, making sure that Red Hat as a whole is getting all the benefits possible out of the open source business model that it has chosen—which means building successful communities. The other focus is still in the Fedora space, where we participate more or less the same way we always have, as some of the 'senior leaders' in the Fedora community.

Q Tell us something about the Fedora infrastructure. What are the different facilities provided by the project to the contributors and what is expected in return?

The Fedora Infrastructure team, led by Mike McGrath, doesn't get nearly the credit it deserves. It is arguably the most critical piece of the entire Fedora community, because it provides everyone in the project with the raw materials necessary to do their jobs. It's massively volunteer-driven, and I believe that it is more innovative, and provides better services than most fully-staffed and enormously-budgeted IT departments in many companies.

There are a lot of things I could talk about here, but in the interest of keeping the answer short I'll mention the work that we call 'Fedora Hosted' and 'Fedora People', because it is an example of a proactive infrastructure team understanding the needs of a development community and giving them the tools necessary to get their work done.

Fedora Hosted provides repositories, Trac instances, and wikis for various upstream projects that are associated with Fedora. The project is a little bit over a year old now, and it has grown tremendously, to the point where even many Red Hat employees are using it because it is better than some of Red Hat's internal tools that try to serve the same needs.

Similarly, Fedora People provides every contributor with some Web space that can be used for personal git repositories, mockups, etc. This space is activated along with a person's Fedora Account.

Q Among Fedora Project contributors are RH employees and volunteers. How do you ensure that the project as a whole is not directed by the interests of RH (as it's the primary sponsor) rather than those of the community?

The answer to this is actually quite simple. There is one set of rules, and everyone plays by it. If you want a feature in Fedora, the process is clear. It doesn't matter if you work for Red Hat, or if you are a student hacking in your spare time. If you follow the processes—managed by John Poelstra, our rock star Fedora Project Manager—then you get your work into Fedora. If you don't follow the processes, then you wait until the next release.

Q How does the Fedora Project facilitate Red Hat? Also, what do the two entities expect from each other?

The Fedora Project is upstream for Red Hat Enterprise Linux. Red Hat expects that the Fedora Project will provide innovation, and constantly represent the best of what exists in the open source universe today.

In return, the Fedora Project expects that Red Hat Enterprise Linux will take the best of what exists today, and turn it into a supportable product that represents the best of what will exist for the next seven years. The revenue made by Red Hat's enterprise products allows for (among other things) continued growth and investment in Fedora.

It's a very symbiotic relationship.